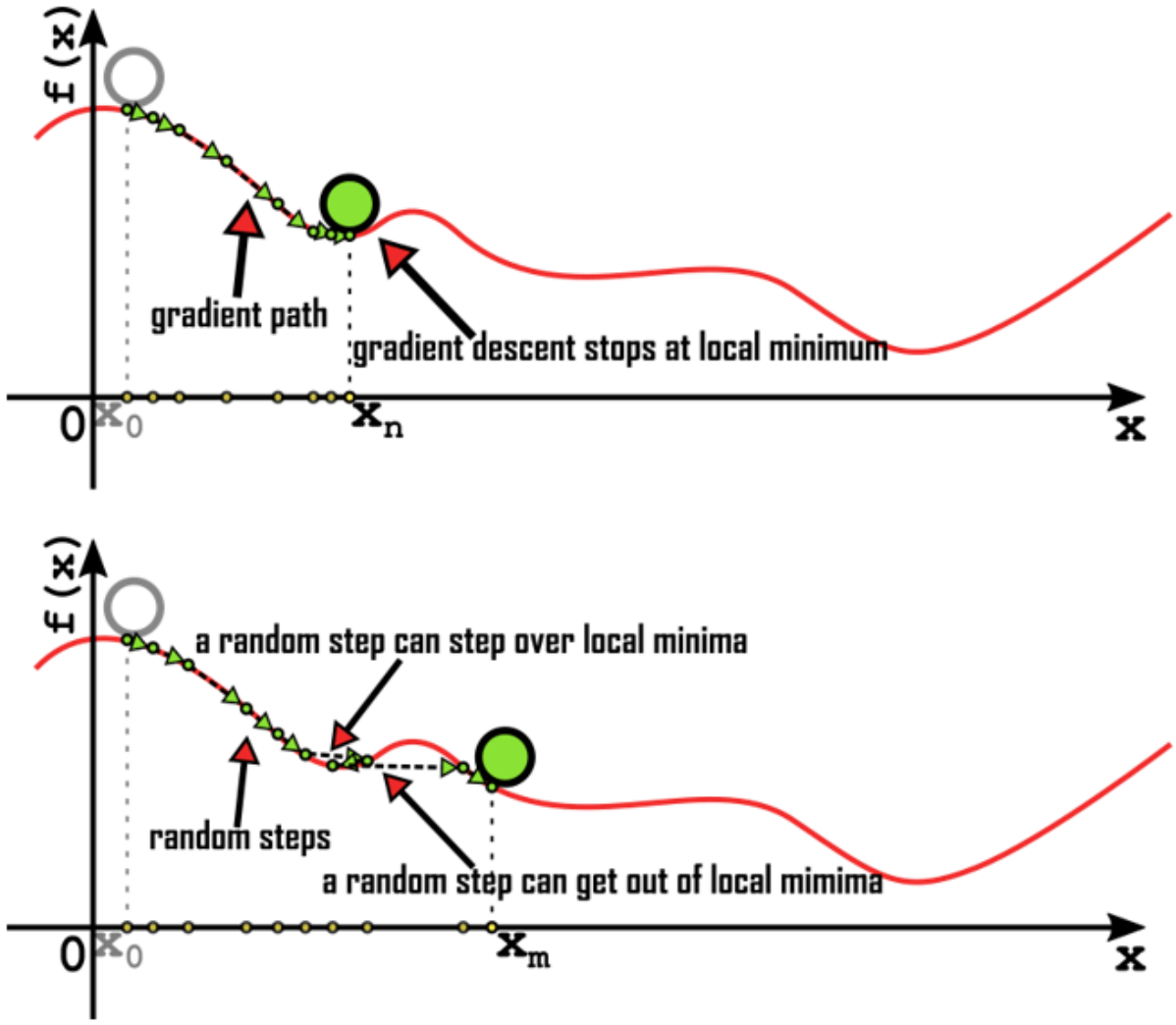


Figure 17.1 Gradient descent versus local random optimization. While for gradient descent steps are proportional to the curve's steepness, the random steps are… just random (within a reasonable radius). That's why it's easier to the random algorithm to step over a local minimum, or even get out of it (technically both are possible for gradient descent as well, as we have seen in chapter 16, depending on the learning rate and shape of the cost function).